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Executive Summary

The Springfield council meeting on June 16, 2026 approved the agenda, minutes, several bylaws, and the 2026 election rates, while also recognizing an employee's contributions and approving a modest sports appropriation. A public speaker raised concerns about financial reporting transparency and suggested adding a Management Discussion & Analysis to quarterly reports. The council decided not to proceed with zoning bylaw 2125, opting to draft a clean new bylaw for future readings, and discussed actions to improve document accessibility and public communication.

Key Discussion Points

- Agenda was amended to move item 9.2 to new business and approved unanimously
- Second and third readings of Bylaw 2606 authorizing borrowing for Springfield Road were passed
- Council recognized Amber Seminchuk for her volunteer work
- Election official rates for the 2026 municipal election were set
- Financial statements for Jan-Mar 2026 were approved
- A \$750 appropriation was approved for youth football player Ethan Weed
- Council voted to halt zoning bylaw 2125 and start a new, clean bylaw
- Public comment highlighted the need for clearer financial reporting and suggested an MD&A supplement

Decisions Made

- Agenda approved with amendment moving item 9.2 to new business
- Council minutes from June 2, 2026 adopted
- Bylaw 2606 second reading approved
- Bylaw 2606 third reading approved
- Letter of congratulations to Amber Seminchuk approved on consent agenda
- Election rates for 2026 municipal election approved (item 10.1)
- Financial statements for Jan-Mar 2026 approved (item 10.2)
- Appropriation of \$750 for Ethan Weed football approved (item 10.3)
- Resolution to not proceed with zoning bylaw 2125 and to draft a new bylaw approved (item 10.4)

Action Items

Task	Owner	Deadline
Publish the council-mentioned magazine article on the municipality website	Deputy Mayor	-
Provide a clean, non-tracked version of the revised zoning bylaw for public review	Planning Office	-
Print hard-copy copies of the revised zoning bylaw for council members	Council Administration	-
Explore adding a Management Discussion & Analysis supplement to quarterly financial reports	Council/Administration	-

Schedule the first reading of the new zoning bylaw and set a timeline for its adoption	Council	-
Record the employee recognition letter in official council minutes	Council Clerk	-

Risks & Issues

- [!] Potential confusion among staff and public due to multiple versions of zoning bylaw 2125
- [!] Lack of clear, plain-language financial reporting could reduce public trust
- [!] Delays in producing clean bylaw copies may postpone the first reading

Full Transcript

Thank you very much. This is the arm of Springfield meeting agenda for June 16th of 2026 starting at exactly 6 p.m. I'm Mayor Patrick Tarian who is calling the meeting to order. All councillors are present and I'll identify them in descending order. Next to me in descending is deputy mayor fuel counselors Kaczynski Miller and Warren I'll do a land acknowledgement the arm of Springfield acknowledges that we are gathered on ancestral lands treaty one territory traditional territory Anishinaabe Cree Oji Cree Dakota Denny's people on the national homeland of the Red River River Métis and then I got the item number four here if people are following the approval of the agenda I like to make one move I'd like to move nine point two that's the Municipal Board long file number referral of objections to zoning bylaw 2125 move that to ten point four under the new business so just the one one change moving out from consent to a new business any other issues or movements at all I see none then if I can get us actually can I get a move on a second for that please that'd be worn in the fuel then I'm gonna get a show of hands approval of the agenda as specified unanimous so carried Adoption of the minutes, please move our seconder, Warren and Fuel. Any issues or concerns regarding council minutes of June 2nd of 2026? I see none. Then if I can get a show of hands of those in support. That is unanimous, so carried. We have a delegation. We're a bit fast on that, so maybe we can move to item 7, go to the bylaws. I'm sorry, 7.1. That's the bylaw 2606, amending boardroom bylaw 2124. Can I get a mover and a seconder for that, please? Warren and Fuel? be resolved that second reading be given to bylaw number 2606 being a bylaw of the arm of springfield council authorized borrowing under municipal board order number e dash 21-140 regarding borrowing bylaw 2124 for springfield road holland street thank you with that being read if i can get a show of hands first for those in support that is unanimous and so carried that was the second reading if we can go to the third reading under the same title there and this is 7.11 the mover and a seconder please warren and fuel be it resolved that third and final reading be given to bylaw number 2606 being a bylaw of the arm of Springfield cancel authorized borrowing under municipal board order number e-21-140 regarding borrowing bylaw 2124 for Springfield Road Holland Street with that being read can I pose the question first of those in support of the third reading that is unanimous and so carried then we can go to consent agenda we're way ahead there just keep going in okay why don't we go to the consent agenda as specified we're moving a nine point two from the consent agenda but all the other items at nine point one three four five and six I think that's it sorry and seven after I like to read the letter of congratulations to one of our employees from springfield heritage housing everybody's good with that uh with the consent agenda can i get a mover in a second or please uh counselor fuel and warren and i'll pose the uh question of those in support of the show of hands those unanimous i'd like to read the letter sent to us by springfield heritage and housing and with one of our employees there recognition to amber semen chuck um oh i am good okay this is a letter dated may the 18th of 2026 to our ceo on behalf of springfield heritage housing incorporated there. I wish to express our sincere gratitude for the help of your Amber Seminchuk, Community Resource Coordinator for the Army of Springfield. I first met Amber when she was new to her role. It was clear she was already making the extra effort to attend community events, to meet with stakeholders and to learn about the community and how she could contribute to improving lives of seniors in Springfield. She then offered direct support and was extremely helpful in our Time and Talent fundraiser event. Her assistance contributed to a highly successful result. She prepared printed materials, helped in the setup and was there to finish helping to coordinate the auction process. She also has willingly helped with another planning fundraiser event. speaking with her recently I realize all her help to do a place was done on her own time after hours she made a personal decision to do this as a volunteer not on the staff time I believe amber should be recognized for her commitment to this community congratulations on a great new hire for the arm of Springfield she's already making an impact finally without support of the arm of Springfield including all its staff management counselors do the place would not be a a reality thank you for your support signed leslie thompson so congratulations to amber it's a it's a good recognition to have um if you never mind where i am um councillor warren thank you mayor i just wanted to um let everybody acknowledge that on the consent agenda 9.7 it's a magazine article and I think it's a good read. Oh, yes. So I would encourage residents and council, if you haven't read it, to just peruse it and see what you think. Thanks. Thank you. Deputy Mayor? Yeah, I'd like to make one more comment to that. Once you read the article, it's like a tool. Going into debt is like a tool. when you own a business i've gone in debt a few times in business to grow my business and this is the same way this is to improve the community with infrastructure and all those kinds of infrastructure items infrastructure items and you know it's like a bridge financing also so it allows you to build while things are less costly and as things get more and more expensive um you already

got the shovel in the ground and you're going in at a lesser cost as the example is i guess we can always talk about our rec center you know it's always taken a long time to be built now we've got the shovel in the ground we've got our costs and uh hopefully it becomes a good project for the whole community so i just want to express that thank you thank you i want to thank council warren for bringing it up there because uh the article is exceptional it's a very easy read It's two pages, two and a little bit there. It does specifically show a place, a millennium place. It's a recreational center in Strathcona County. This is Canadian, so I assume where it is and what province, it's probably in here somewhere else there But they invested in their new recreational center They call it a recreation facility million there and then they had a projection and four years later the similar facility has almost doubled its price, sorry I'm bad at math, it's \$45 million. And today's dollars, this is built in 2000, it would cost about \$120 million to build. And again, as the Deputy Mayor and Councillor Warren had mentioned there, it's an exceptional read. I think maybe we should actually even put this on the website there. But that's all I can say with regards to that. Any other comments at all? That's about it. Have we voted on that yet? And we're still waiting for 6.15 for that. I think if we can go to maybe 10.1 under new business, that's 2026 election rates. Okay. Maybe if we can go to election rates, that will give Mr. Giesbrich some time here, if we can finish off that on the new business. Oh, I'm sorry. Can I get a mover and seconder for 10.1? This is where we're at. They're Miller and Kaczynski. Council of the Arm of Springfield approve the following rates for preparation of the 2026 municipal election voting officials \$250 for election day information officers \$300 for election day training \$50 per training session and mileage at 70 cents per kilometer questions comments from my counsel I see none if I can get a show hands of those in support of the new business 10.1 the gin animus is so carried mr. Giesbrich would you want to start five minutes early okay we'll get you seated there and I want to present your name and so on then we'll start Thank you. like. Yeah, I can hear you. Yeah. Yeah. I hear it. Okay. Check, check. Okay. Speak up a little bit. Good evening, Mr. Chair and members of council for the record. My name is Edwin Giesbrecht, resident of the RM of Springfield and a registered candidate for mayor. Before I begin, I would like to note that accountability, transparency and responsible stewardship of public resources have been reoccurring themes of my public advocacy and my comments. And my comments this evening are consistent with those principles. principles. For clarity, PSAB or the public sector accounting board establishes the accounting standards used by Canadian municipalities and other public sector organizations in many respects. It serves a role similar to GAAP or generally accepted accounting principles in the private sector. These standards determine how revenues, expenditures, reserves and capital projects are recorded presented in both monthly and audited financial statements using that framework i've reviewed municipalities january through march 2026 financial statements alongside approximately 10 years of audited financial results covering the period from 2015 through 2024. the audited record over that period reflects long-term financial stability including sustained surpluses, growth in accumulated surplus and reduce long-term debt. However, the monthly financial statements show significant variation in short-term operating results, reserve activity and the timing of revenues and expenditures. In particular, the March 2026 reporting period reflects a significant variance that would benefit from a clear explanation within the financial statements or accompanying report so that residents can better understand the information being presented. I fully acknowledge that monthly reporting is not equivalent to audited annual financial statements and that PSAB accounting standards, timing differences and capital project cycles all affect how financial information is presented throughout the year. Nevertheless, accountability requires that financial reporting be clear not only to professionals but to the residents who ultimately fund municipal operations and taxpayers have a right to know how their money is being used and managed from that perspective it is important that monthly reporting can be clearly reconciled with audited annual financial results without ambiguity or confusion january and in February provided context, while March provided the clearest illustration of the questions I raised this evening. After reviewing a decade of audited financial results and preparing extensive public analysis, I believe there is an opportunity to improve how complex financial information is communicated to the residents. In my view, accountability is strengthened when financial information is not only accurate and publicly available, but also understandable to the residents it serves. I would note that many leading corporations, public authorities and government organizations now supplement their financial reporting with what is commonly referred to as a management discussion and analysis or a MD and a the purpose is not to replace audited financial statements or establish accounting standards, but to provide a plain language context that helps citizens, stakeholders, and decision makers understand significant variances, financial trends, and the practical implications of the information being presented. In many sectors, management discussion and analysis has become widely regarded as the gold standard for bridging the gap between technical financial reporting and meaningful public understanding.

This reflects an important principle of governance. Transparency is not merely publishing information, but communicating it in a manner people can understand. While I'm not suggesting any specific reporting model be adopted, I do believe Council may wish to consider whether supplementary explanatory reporting of this nature could further strengthen public understanding and confidence and engagement with the municipality's financial reporting process. An informed public is not a challenge to good government. It is one of its greatest assets. Accordingly, I respectfully request clarification from administration on how monthly revenue recognition aligns with audited annual reporting practices how reserve transfers are categorized and communicated through the fiscal year what explains the significant variance observed in March, 2026 within normal operational context, and how council ensures that monthly reporting remains fully transparent and understandable in relation to audited financial statements. I would also note that in a previous delegation, I submitted approximately 16 one-page graphs as part of a substantial analysis derived from 10 years of audited municipal financial statements. The material was provided to and reviewed by both council and administration and was specifically prepared to help bridge the gap between technical financial reporting and public understanding. the graphs and accompanying explanations presented in a manner intended to be accessible to residents and taxpayers. To the best of my knowledge, however, those materials have not been made available through the municipality's website, therefore remain unavailable to the residents seeking to review them. While council and administration may or may not agree with the observations or conclusions contained within the analysis, I believe residents should have the opportunity to review the same material that was formally submitted and considered through the public process and reach their own conclusions, particularly where it relates to the stewardship of public funds and the municipality's long-term financial position. Residents cannot meaningfully hold their government accountable if information that has been formally submitted and considered through the public process is not readily accessible to them and informed public is not a threat to good government it is one of its foundations i believe this council holds a continuing duty to the residents to access exercise stewardship and accountability in the decisions it makes including those made since 2022 and with those considerations in mind I would respectfully ask council to consider how past approvals and policy directions have shaped the financial position and reporting now being presented to the public and whether residents are receiving the clarity necessary to make informed judgments about those outcomes. My intent is not to question integrity but to ensure that accountability, transparency, and public understanding principles that form part of my vision for Springfield are reflected not only in outcomes but in how clearly those outcomes are communicated to the public. In closing, accountability is not only about financial performance but about the clarity, transparency and public accessibility of how that performance is presented to the people who fund it. It is also a matter of fiduciary duty to act in the best interests of the taxpayers. Good government depends upon an informed public. And an informed public depends upon access to clear and understandable information. In my view, that is not merely an administrative objective. it is a democratic responsibility. With these considerations in mind, I respectfully leave council, administration, and the Springfield Taxpayer Rights Corporation with a constructive challenge to work together toward an implementable management discussion and analysis framework that could accompany future quarterly financial reporting. I believe I have planted the seed of that idea this evening. Whether it grows into a useful tool for greater transparency, accountability and public understanding is now a matter for our current council and administration. Good government is not measured solely by what information is published, but by whether the public can reasonably understand it. Thank you for your time. I wish Council, administration and all residents of Springfield a constructive day. Thank you very much, Mr. Giesbrich. I just want to clarify, you are not an accountant? No. Okay. And you are running for office in the next election as the Mayor? That is a matter of record. Yeah. And you said that, so I just wanted to make sure of that. You have to be aware these aren't any really questions. This is comments. All our financial statements are audited by an independent auditor through the province under the municipal act there. Our accountant, our CFO officer, I call him CFO, I'm not sure of the exact title unfortunately, but he is an accountant. So no one in council has an issue with the monthly reports, I don't. And I'm the only one in council that's not business run. Allison Council here has their own business and are far more qualified with regards to budgets there. So I'm not going to start expanding that. I know about all the budgets, but I've learned a lot in the four years that I've been in office here. And nobody's ever had an issue with the accountant there or the principal of accounting there. You said PB or whatever the term is there. So all our reports are published on our website. Everybody has an access to it, such as yourself there and you access that so on stewardship is is a principal under the administration for the accounting and falls under our CEO and we have an extreme amount of what to call that honor with regards to amram and his and his accounting there so you're the

only person that I know that I know you're trying to tweak it and make it better there but what we have so far in my opinion is is running well but i thank you very much for your time and your insight on that i thank you and i thank you council for considering an md and a because that is not a swipe against anybody that's not a swipe against amram it is only an evolution and an improvement yeah and i realize that and i thank you thank you for qualifying that there but amram is an accountant there and i know about accounting there i have a friend that's an accountant it's a it's a an exhaustive degree thank you very much then if we can go to back to sorry um 10.2 please that's financial statements uh for january february and march of 2026. can i get a mover seconder please fuel and warn any questions comments with regards to those statements for january february and march of 2026 i see none then if i can get a show of hands so be resolved that the financial statements for the month of january february and march 2026 be approved as presented thank you without being red first i'll pose a question for those in support to show hands as unanimous is so carried then we go to award appropriations to please a 10.3 mover seconder please Miller and the Terrian If I can make some kind of a suggestion next time with my site getting old, if we can make this a little bit bigger. Even if I expand it, I can't really see it. It takes a while and it's out of focus, but that's just me. You want to take that So we have one request from let find it here Ethan Weed from the U18 team that football team I think it should be a general request from citizens from the council It's costing possibly \$2,800 per player. and we got we got Ethan in the audience here as well he's the smallest guy in the audience I'm back so yeah there is a request for support for attending so just open it up to council for suggested amounts okay I I would like to contribute it's Ethan's he seems he's doing very well in this football there he's accelerated immensely there at the sport relatively new to himself but he's doing quite well and I always want to support our Springfield athletes in whatever sport and we have in the past there and I would I would look at 150 for for Ethan for that I'd like to match that I will contribute 152 on that go ahead and I'll match as well okay I will do the resolution be resolved that the following 2026 board appropriations be approved Ethan weed Ethan weeb football Manitoba seven hundred and fifty dollars with that being read if I get a show of hands of those in support those unanimous so carried Thank You Ethan for showing up here it's nice to see a person in the audience there that's actually here so I appreciate that very much and good luck to you out there who's taller now you or your dad you say that was such pride right on okay then I think that's it oh I'm sorry yeah a 10 point point four please if we can get that can I get a mover and a seconder for that'll be the municipal board file number 26 b3s or one referral of objections to zoning bylaw 2125 if I get a mover and a seconder for that please that'll be Miller or Warren and the fuel So just for background on this, so Council has a copy of the Municipal Board regarding Zoning By-law 2125, the decision. So the decision basically came back that the referral of the by-law to the board was not valid. At this point, Council's had a brief discussion with administration about next steps for this by-law. recommendation going forward from staff is uh it's there seems to be a lot of confusion and especially written within the municipal board explains there's a lot of versions of the bylaw that are out there people were confused which version was being approved at which stage of the public hearing process so after speaking with community planning and legal counsel the recommendation put forward to council was that a resolution should be passed to not proceed with the zoning bylaw number 2125 and to take that similar bylaw pretty much the exact and just put a new bylaw number on it and start the process over with the first reading at a future meeting uh open up the council any questions comments And I see none. Then if I can do, Gonsfer Kaczynski. Thank you. I want to know, I didn't read that because we didn't have enough time for the new and improved, I guess, proposal to the zoning by-law, the new zoning by-law. My one question is, is this zoning by-law proposal same that was given to the municipal board on the day of the municipal board hearing? No, it's very similar. It's accepted the 53 plus changes that were recommended, plus the four additional that came out at the last public hearing. and we've just done some general cleanup. There was some definitions to signs that was included. I think the planning office, when they discussed it with council, there was just different words that they reviewed and tightened up. So that will all be part of the first reading bylaw for the public and council to review. And when are we going to have first reading? We're just working on that timeline now. Okay. And the changes are there in this new revised document? It'll be a clean by-law, so there's not going to be any track changes. We will put the by-law forward as being presented to council. But if it's the same as what was presented to municipal board originally, not on the day of the hearings how are we going to know which changes was put in that new bylaw so council was provided with that track change document showing all of the changes but we don't want to go out with a bunch of versions with track changes that seems to confuse everything when we put it out in the public so council has received that so you'll know what the changes are but the first reading bylaw will be one clean bylaw put forward for review by the public so we as a council we're going to have input to it if we're going to change check

those revisions and everything else yes of course so it's going to be timetabled that we can do that now secondly the the this new revised copy it's so large can we asking that we're going to get receive a print of it because it's very hard to read on the ipad for council to receive copies yes yeah you can request that from the office okay i appreciate that thank you that's just your copy you're talking about counselor kazinsky okay yeah copies can be made available to the public at a costs yeah okay thank you okay uh any other questions i see none and if we do the resolution uh there we can uh do a vote be resolved that the municipality not proceed with arm springfield zoning bylaw number 2125 with that being read first of all i would uh the first question uh and our question is those in support with a show of hands councillors warren fuel ontarian those opposed counselors Miller Kaczynski is so past and that is the end of our meeting here at 635 can I get a mover in a second or two closed the meeting Warren and fuel can I get a show hands to close the meeting is closed under unanimous vote at 634 thank you very much